

Singh is not alone in raising the banner of revolt. Arun Shourie, the other scholar gentleman in the Parivar, has been equally forthright in his criticism of the central leadership and others. At the Parliamentary Party Committee meeting on June 9, Shourie blasted Advani's close aide Sudheendra Kulkarni and Arun Jaitley, who was the campaign chief and is now the leader of the Opposition in Rajya Sabha, for blaming everyone else and exonerating themselves through newspaper articles. Kulkarni argued that the RSS was the main villain as it made prime ministerial candidate Advani "look weak". Jaitley too preferred an op-ed page to analyse the party's poor performance, and it was not a piece of mea culpa. Singh was not amused by the newspaper articles of the strategists who are seeking excuses for their own failures. "Is a war within the party the only answer to comments made in newspapers?" he asked.

The BJP leader also wrote in his letter that there was no connection between rewards in the party and the

Jaswant's Arrows

The political circumstances today are screaming for collective introspection. If it is not done, the party will have to suffer more losses. There is no doubt about it.

When the top leadership accepts responsibility, why don't other leaders and the election managers accept their responsibility? Hence the question: is there any connection between rewards and results? The attitude is: the credit for success is ours, let others take the responsibility for defeat.

Is the right to comment on election results reserved for those managing it? Why so? What is the solution? Is a war within the party the only answer to comments written in newspapers?

Wherever the party has lost an election, we do an analysis. We do not know the results of these analyses till today. There is still no analysis of the 2004 election results or of the Rajasthan Assembly polls. Is the 2009 election analysis going to meet the same fate?

The party has no coherent policy. It is like playing ideological football in an open field. Anybody can kick anywhere in absence of a goal. Everybody can come up with a new ideology.



results. It was a clear reference to the elevation of Jaitley despite his disastrous performance as the chief campaign manager in both the Assembly and Lok Sabha elections. This is a sentiment shared by several others in the party, particularly at a time when such

dependable warhorses like Yashwant Sinha and Shanta Kumar are being sidelined. Singh said there is a growing sense of hopelessness among the party workers. "The BJP should not be a party of yesterday," he told INDIA TODAY.

It was a distant yesterday when the

rise of the BJP marked a historic right turn in Indian politics. It took only five years for the party to turn the romance into a terrible banality. The humiliation of 2004 should have been a new beginning, but the BJP continued to sink deeper in defeatism. As a party hardened by its struggle against power, the BJP could have made better use of the last five years that gave it enough opportunities to realise the uses of adversity. As the leadership continued to distance itself from India, the party began to wither away. Today, the BJP is a prisoner of the collective desperation of the few people who have brought it to the current irredeemable state. A cabal of apparatchiks whose constituency doesn't extend beyond the drawing rooms of Delhi has become the custodian of the party, and it has the patronage of its tallest leader. As Singh suggests, it is the reward for killing an idea with such strategic precision. Now a few honourable men want to retrieve the lost soul of the Indian Right.